

Golden Standards Concepts

[Original Document](#), submitted here since finding it on Confluence wasn't an option.

What Does Standardizing Jira Mean?

We do not own team development processes; we help teams to be more efficient in how they work using Enterprise tooling by standardizing how the tools are used. Standardizing how we use Jira means project teams in the Disney Entertainment and the ESPN Product and Technology organization on the centralized Enterprise instance of the Jira platform use templated frameworks outlined in the documentation on this site. By definition, teams that use Jira outside the prescribed standards immediately break organizational standards and run the risk of adversely impacting initiative reporting and velocity.

What are we Standardizing?

- **Standardized Definitions covering:**
 - Ticket Types
 - Statuses and Sub Statuses
 - Project Linking
 - Core Fields
- **Standardized Jira Project Templates** - Include two organizational-level project templates and three squad-level templates that work cross-functionally.
- **Standardized Project Linking** - Provides a clear reporting path showing progress, health, and velocity on crucial portfolio initiatives.
- **Standardized Sub Statuses** - Meet the functional needs of teams while reducing cross-discipline confusion.
- **Project Hierarchies** - Outline clear reporting paths through common usage of links and ticket types in each project build.
- **Standardized Core Jira Fields** - Teams use these across all projects to clarify reporting and increase communication effectiveness.

Standardized Ticket Types



Objective

The “Objective” ticket types (L2) are typically shorter-term goals set by DE&E Product and Technology Executive Leadership. They contain measurable actions to achieve the Strategic Priority that the Objective rolls up to. Objectives have a one-to-many relationship with the Strategic Goals. All Objectives in the Technology Roadmap base should have a corresponding Objective ticket within the TRP project in Jira.

Availability: Only in the organizational-level TRP project.



Initiative

The “Initiative” ticket types (L3) are programs and projects that drive demonstrable progress against an Objective. L3s are time-bound. This is the level at which work is sized, prioritized, resourced (budgeted), and traded off. DEEP & Tech Divisions submit these tickets. Initiatives have a one-to-many relationship to Objectives. All Initiatives in the Technology Roadmap base should have a corresponding Initiative in the TRP project in Jira.



Deliverable

Deliverables are the incremental deliveries of an Initiative. The sum of Deliverables equals the whole of the Strategic Initiative. These are determined within the team executing the Initiative. There can be “major” Deliverables that are used as phases within an Initiative. Deliverables have a many-to-one relationship to Initiatives. In some use cases, Deliverables will be used in place of feature epics. All Deliverables in the Technology Roadmap base should have a corresponding Deliverable in the TRP project in Jira.

Availability: Only in the organizational-level TRP project.

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Epic

An “Epic” is a large body of work or product feature that is broken down into smaller tasks or user stories (although epics are sometimes created as individual user stories). Epics are used to organize work and can span multiple sprints, teams, and releases.

For Ad Platforms, *Product* creates two types of Epics:

- **Feature Epic:** *What they want to achieve.*
- **Functional Epic:** *for product to deliver a piece of that feature.*

Epics are a one-to-one match with Milestones or Releases in the Technology Roadmap Airtable base.

Story

A “Story” (also known as a user story) is a small, self-contained unit of development work designed to accomplish a specific goal within a product. A story is usually written from the user’s perspective and follows the “As, I Want, So That” format. As an example, the Ad Platforms team uses the Story ticket to drive how the team is going to deliver the functionality. Stories can be used in PRODREQ and Squad projects.

Task

A “Task” is a part of a story and represents a specific piece of work that needs to be completed to achieve a particular goal defined in a user story. Task issues are individual tasks that are identified and tracked during the software development process. Tasks can be used in PRODREQ and Squad projects.

SubTask

A “Subtask” represents a smaller, individual piece of work that is part of a larger parent issue task. It helps break down complex projects into more easily manageable steps and assigns different aspects of the main task to various team members. A subtask is essentially a child task of a parent task that contributes to completing the overall goal. Subtasks are available in Squad Projects.

Bug

A “Bug” is a defect or similar problem in a software product or code that affects performance, functionality, or user experience. Bugs can range from minor visual issues to critical failures of the software being developed. Bugs are available in Squad Project 1 and Squad Project 2.

Spike

A “Spike” represents a time-boxed task dedicated to research, investigation, or experimentation to address uncertainties or risks within a project. A spike is a short burst of exploration – gathering information to help teams better understand a complex issue so they can estimate the time and effort needed before committing to a full development effort on a feature. Spikes are available in Squad Project 1 and Squad Project 2.

Standardized Core Fields

Workforce Fields

The following fields selection lists will be populated from an integration between Jira and Workforce. The options within the select list cannot be manually modified.

Alliance

Our strategic level, where we prioritize initiatives, align resources, establish and measure Objectives and Key Results (OKRs), and coordinate with lines of business and other alliances.

The Alliances field identifies the Alliance or Alliances assigned to or working on the ticket. The Alliances drop-down list will remain synchronized with those defined in Workforce. At certain points in the workflow, this field is locked for editing (view-only). This occurs as it syncs with the Fleets and Squads selected in tickets at a lower hierarchy.

Fleet

Our tactical level, where we drive day-to-day execution and progress, develop and manage plans, and track progress against commitments.

The Fleets field identifies the Fleets assigned to or working on the ticket. The Fleets drop-down list will remain synchronized with those defined in Workforce. Fleets are defined within the TRP project level. At certain points in the workflow, this field is locked for editing (view-only).

Squad

Our task level, where we develop and build specific features or project elements, deliver reporting and issue escalation, break down and estimate tasks, and prioritize backlog.

The Squad field identifies which Squad is assigned to or working on the ticket. The Squads drop-down list will remain synchronized with those defined in Workforce. Squads are selected in the Squad level ticket hierarchy and filter up to the TRP project level based on the ticket linking.

Jira Fields

Plans

The Plans field outlines the key priorities, milestones, and deliverables scheduled for the upcoming 3-4 weeks, providing a clear roadmap for short-term goals and activities.

Teams should update this field on a regular schedule. The data within this field will report up to the Initiative tickets and it will link to the Initiative in the Technology Roadmap Airtable base. It is used for reporting, including but not limited to Dashboards, Airtable, or Tableau.

Progress

The Progress field provides a short description of an Epic's progress, reporting on whether it is moving forward as planned or encountering delays or obstacles.

This field rolls up into the Executive summary field within the Initiative tickets and it links to the Initiative in the Technology Roadmap Airtable base. It is used for reporting, including but not limited to Dashboards, Airtable or Tableau.

Problems

The Problems field identifies challenges or barriers hindering the completion of planned work, including dependencies, resource constraints, or technical issues. This field is combined with the Progress and Plans fields to generate the Executive Summary within Initiative tickets, and it links to the Initiative in the Technology Roadmap Airtable base. It's used for reporting, including but not limited to Dashboards, Airtable or Tableau.

More fields like [Airtable Fields](#) at [SharePoint Jira Standards](#).

